The big advantage of `WebApplicationFactory` is that you can easily test your real app's behavior. That power comes with responsibility: your app will behave as it would in real life, so it will write to a database and send to third-party APIs! Depending on what you're testing, you may want to replace some of your dependencies to avoid this, as well as to make testing easier.

36.3.3 Replacing dependencies in WebApplicationFactory

When you use `WebApplicationFactory` to run integration tests on your app, your app will be running in-memory, but other than that, it's as though you're running your application using `dotnet run`. That means any connection strings, secrets, or API keys that can be loaded locally will also be used to run your application.

TIP By default, `WebApplicationFactory` uses the `"Development"` hosting environment, the same as when you run locally.

On the plus side, that means you have a genuine test that your application can start correctly. For example, if you've forgotten to register a required DI dependency that is detected on application startup, any tests that use `WebApplicationFactory` will fail.

On the downside, that means all your tests will be using the same database connection and services as when you run your application locally. It's common to want to replace those with alternative test versions of your services.